PAPER

DIGITAL ECONOMY

THE IMPACT OF KKI ON THE BENGKALIS ECONOMY

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PREFACE

Praise be to God Almighty for His abundant grace and blessings, enabling the author to complete this paper entitled “The Impact of the 2026 Indonesian Ship Contest (KKI) on MSMEs, Tourism, and Education on Bengkalis Island” on time.

This paper was prepared based on the results of an interview with a local trader who sold goods during the KKI event, supported by field observations and documentation. The author hopes this paper can provide a picture of the impact of the KKI event from the perspective of a small business operator around the event location.

The author would like to thank the informant who was willing to take the time to be interviewed, the supervising lecturer for the guidance and direction provided, and all parties who helped in the preparation of this paper.

The author realizes that this paper still has shortcomings. Therefore, constructive criticism and suggestions are greatly appreciated for future improvement. May this paper be useful to readers.

KKI Bengkalis September 2026

Group II

TABLE OF CONTENTS

PREFACE ..... **i**

TABLE OF CONTENTS ..... **ii**

CHAPTER I INTRODUCTION **1**

1.1 Background 1

1.2 Problem Formulation 1

1.3 Purpose of Writing 2

1.4 Benefits of Writing 2

1.5 Writing Method 2

CHAPTER II DISCUSSION **3**

2.1 Overview of KKI 2026 3

2.2 Profile of the Informant and Their Business 3

2.3 Impact on MSMEs and Trading Businesses 4

2.4 Impact on Tourism 6

2.5 Impact on Education 7

2.6 Overall Assessment and Informant's Hopes 8

CHAPTER III CLOSING **9**

3.1 Conclusion 9

3.2 Suggestions 9

REFERENCES **10**

APPENDIX **11**

CHAPTER I
INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background

The Indonesian Ship Contest (KKI) is a national-level competition for university students aimed at improving skills, creativity, and innovation in the fields of maritime technology and ship design. This event is organized by the Directorate of Learning and Student Affairs (Belmawa), Directorate General of Higher Education, Ministry of Higher Education, Science, and Technology (Kemendiktisaintek, 2026).

In 2026, KKI was held at the Bengkalis State Polytechnic, Riau, from 14 to 17 September 2026 (RRI, 2026; Okezone, 2026). Bengkalis Island was chosen as the location because of its strategic position bordering directly on the Malacca Strait, providing students with a real learning environment to understand the maritime world (RRI, 2026).

National-scale events such as KKI bring many participants, organizing committee members, and visitors to the host region. This influx of people opens up economic opportunities for the local community, especially micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs) selling goods around the event location. In addition, this event also has the potential to introduce the region as a tourist destination and serve as a learning tool for the younger generation.

This impact is felt most directly by local traders who interact directly with visitors. Therefore, the author is interested in exploring the experience of a local trader who sold goods during KKI 2026 to find out how the event affected their business, the tourism sector, and education on Bengkalis Island.

1.2 Problem Formulation

Based on the background above, the problem formulation in this paper is as follows.

1. What is the business profile of the informant who sold goods during KKI 2026?
2. What is the impact of KKI on MSMEs and trading businesses around the event location?

3. What is the impact of KKI on tourism on Bengkalis Island?
4. What is the impact of KKI on education and academia?
5. What is the informant's assessment of and hopes for the future organization of KKI?

1.3 Purpose of Writing

The purposes of writing this paper are as follows.

1. To describe the business profile of the informant who sold goods during KKI 2026.
2. To determine the impact of KKI on MSMEs and trading businesses.
3. To determine the impact of KKI on tourism on Bengkalis Island.
4. To determine the impact of KKI on education and academia.
5. To determine the informant's assessment of and hopes for the future organization of KKI.

1.4 Benefits of Writing

The expected benefits of writing this paper are as follows.

1. For the author, to gain insight and experience in collecting field data.
2. For readers, to provide a picture of the impact of KKI from the perspective of a local trader.
3. For the organizing committee and local government, to serve as input for evaluating the organization of similar events.

1.5 Writing Method

This paper was prepared using a descriptive qualitative approach. The primary data were obtained through an interview with one local trader who sold goods during KKI 2026. The interview used a list of questions divided into five sections: business profile, impact on MSMEs, impact on tourism, impact on education, and closing questions.

Supporting data were obtained through direct observation and photo documentation at the event location, as well as document studies and news coverage of KKI 2026. All photos in this paper are the author's own documentation.

Because the interview was conducted with only one informant, the results in this paper describe the informant's experience and are not intended to be generalized to all traders.

CHAPTER II
DISCUSSION

2.1 Overview of KKI 2026

KKI 2026 carried the theme “Garda Maritim Nusantara” (Guardian of the Archipelago's Maritime Domain), focusing on innovation in coast guard ship technology that is robust, responsive, and self-reliant for national sovereignty (Directorate of Learning and Student Affairs, 2026). Through this theme, students were encouraged not only to design ships but also to understand the role of technology in responding to emergency conditions and safeguarding Indonesia's maritime territory (RRI, 2026).

The competition consisted of two main categories: the Innovation Design Competition and the Prototype Competition. This year, a new subcategory was added to the prototype competition in the form of a Remote Operation Underwater Vehicle (ROV) (RRI, 2026).

As host of the finals, Bengkalis State Polytechnic held a series of competitions over four days, from 14 to 17 September 2026 (Okezone, 2026). During the event, the venue was filled with vendor tents selling a variety of food and drinks, as shown in the documentation in this paper.

2.2 Profile of the Informant and Their Business

The informant in this paper is a trader who is a local resident of Bengkalis Island. The informant had only recently started the business and had not been selling at the event location for long. The business operates on a small scale, with products including fried snacks, mixed fruit ice, es teler (mixed fruit and ice dessert), and various other light foods and drinks. A brief profile of the informant is summarized in Table 1, and their stall can be seen in Figure 1.

Because the business was newly established, the informant could not yet confirm an average turnover on regular days. The initial plan was to sell regularly after KKI ended, so there was not yet enough daily sales data to serve as a reference. The informant also had not known about KKI beforehand. However, due to the amount of information circulating, the informant eventually learned about the event and took the opportunity to sell goods there.

Table 1. Brief Profile of the Informant

Aspect	Description
Business status	Newly started; has not been selling at the location for long
Business scale	Small scale
Products sold	Fried snacks, mixed fruit ice, es teler, and various light foods and drinks
Turnover on regular days	Not yet confirmed as the business is newly started
Knowledge of KKI	Did not know beforehand; learned about it from the amount of information circulating



Figure 1. Es teler and assorted beverage stall

2.3 Impact on MSMEs and Trading Businesses

This section describes the informant's experience selling during KKI, covering income, popular products, stock management, challenges, and hopes for the organizers.

2.3.1 Income During KKI

During KKI, the informant earned an average income of around Rp600,000 per day. This figure is still gross revenue, as it has not been reduced by capital costs. The informant could not state the percentage increase in turnover, as the business was newly started and there was no comparison from regular days. Nevertheless, this income remained a meaningful addition for the informant as a novice trader.

2.3.2 Products Sought by Visitors

According to the informant, their products were not particularly sought after, since many other traders sold similar products. However, their goods were still needed by visitors when they felt thirsty or hungry amid the crowds. This shows that sales were driven more by visitors' immediate needs than by any particular product's special appeal.

2.3.3 Merchandise Stock Management

The informant adjusted their stock of goods according to conditions on the ground. When buyers were plentiful and stock ran out early, the informant added more stock to avoid losing customers. This additional stock was not large, as it only came from supplies available at home.

2.3.4 Challenges Faced

The main challenge felt by the informant was competition. Many traders sold the same products, so buyers were spread across many stalls. As a result, the informant's goods only sold out after quite a long time, or when the venue was truly packed with visitors. This condition can be seen in Figures 2 through 4, which show food and fried-snack stalls selling goods in the event area.



Figure 2. Packaged food stall



Figure 3. Assorted food and cakes



Figure 4. Stuffed fried tofu stall

2.3.5 The Need for KKI to Be Held Regularly

The informant believes KKI should be held regularly every year because it helps MSMEs around the location. The large number of visitors creates greater opportunities for traders to attract buyers, which in turn helps the local economy's turnover.

2.3.6 Hopes for the Organizing Committee and Local Government

The informant hopes the organizing committee and local government will pay more attention to the interests of traders, especially local MSME operators. These hopes are as follows.

1. That the arrangement of trading locations be carried out fairly and evenly, so that small and new traders have equal opportunities to sell in strategic spots.
2. That stalls or tents be provided at an affordable cost, or even free of charge for local MSMEs if possible.
3. That the number of traders selling the same type of product be regulated so that competition remains healthy and all traders have a chance to attract buyers.
4. That event promotion be expanded so that more visitors come, including from outside the island.
5. That cleanliness, lighting, and security at the location be maintained throughout the event.
6. That business coaching or training be provided to MSMEs so that traders can develop, not just during KKI.

2.4 Impact on Tourism

2.4.1 Number and Origin of Visitors

The informant observed that the number of visitors increased during KKI. The event attracted public attention, drawing crowds who came to watch the series of activities, as seen in Figure 5.

Most of the visitors the informant encountered came from within Bengkalis Island. This is natural since the event was held on Bengkalis Island, making it easiest for local residents to reach the location. This finding also shows that the presence of tourists from outside the region could still be increased through wider promotion.

2.4.2 KKI as a Means of Promoting Bengkalis

In the informant's personal opinion, KKI helps introduce Bengkalis as a tourist destination. The presence of KKI and coverage from various media have

made Bengkalis' name more widely known, and the informant hopes this can help Bengkalis become known even at the international level. This media coverage can be seen, among other things, in national news reports on the achievements of a student team in the KKI 2026 finals in Bengkalis (Okezone, 2026).

2.4.3 Changes in Facilities Around the Location

The informant also observed changes in facilities around the location during the event, in terms of lighting, the provision of tents, and cleanliness of the area. The atmosphere of the street and the row of stalls in Figure 6 shows the condition of the event area during the activity.



Figure 5. Crowds of visitors in the stall area



Figure 6. Atmosphere of the street and the row of stalls

2.5 Impact on Education

2.5.1 Involvement of Students

The informant saw many school and university students involved in the KKI event. The school students observed came from various levels, from elementary to junior and senior high school, and quite a few university students were also involved.

2.5.2 Benefits for the Younger Generation

According to the informant, events such as KKI are very beneficial for the learning and skill development of the younger generation in Bengkalis. Through KKI, young people have the opportunity to meet people from outside the region and exchange knowledge. From this, they can learn new things they did not previously know, while also sharing knowledge they already have, thereby developing their insight and skills.

2.5.3 Student Visits to the Trader

The informant admitted that no students had previously visited them for coursework or research purposes related to KKI, since the informant is simply a local resident who sells goods. The interview conducted for this paper (Figures 7 and 8) is one example of using KKI as a source of learning outside the classroom.



Figure 7. Interview with a trader at the event location



Figure 8. Documentation at the event location

2.6 Overall Assessment and Informant's Hopes

Overall, the informant felt that the positive impact of KKI was mainly felt personally, by themselves and their family. The income from selling goods during the event became a meaningful addition that helped meet family needs.

As additional input, the informant hopes that KKI will continue to grow and be organized even better in the years to come, and that it can be held again in Bengkalis so that the community can continue to feel its benefits (Figure 9).

From the overall discussion, it can be seen that KKI has a positive impact on the informant, particularly through the increase in the number of buyers. However, this impact is still limited by competition among traders. It should also be noted that this discussion is based on a single informant and therefore does not represent all traders.



Figure 9. A buyer being served at the es teler stall

CHAPTER III
CLOSING

3.1 Conclusion

Based on the results of the interview and discussion in the previous chapter, the following conclusions can be drawn.

1. The informant is a local trader who has recently started a small-scale business selling fried snacks, mixed fruit ice, es teler, and various light foods and drinks. The informant only learned about KKI from the amount of information circulating.
2. For MSMEs, KKI provided additional income averaging around Rp600,000 per day (gross), with competition among traders as the main challenge. The informant believes KKI should be held regularly every year.
3. For tourism, KKI increased the number of visitors, most of whom came from within Bengkalis Island, and according to the informant, helped introduce Bengkalis, accompanied by changes in lighting, tents, and cleanliness of the location.
4. For education, many school and university students were involved in this event, and the informant considers KKI very beneficial because it opens up opportunities to meet people from outside the region and exchange knowledge.
5. Overall, the informant felt the positive impact of KKI mainly benefited themselves and their family, and hoped that KKI would continue to progress and be held again in Bengkalis.

3.2 Suggestions

Based on the results of the discussion, the author offers the following suggestions.

1. For the organizing committee and local government, it is recommended to arrange trading locations fairly, provide affordable stalls, regulate the number of traders selling similar products, expand promotion, maintain

cleanliness, lighting, and security, and provide coaching for local MSMEs.

2. For traders, it is recommended to develop distinctive product features to stand out among the many traders selling similar products.
3. For future researchers, it is recommended to involve more informants, such as other traders, visitors, and organizing committee members, so that the picture of KKI's impact is more complete.

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APPENDIX

Appendix 1. List of Interview Questions and Answers

No.	Question	Informant's Answer
A. OPENING QUESTIONS (BUSINESS PROFILE)		
1.	Since when have you been selling at this location?	I haven't been selling at this location for long. You could say I just started this business, so my selling experience here is still quite short and I'm still in the learning stage.
2.	What type of product or service do you sell?	My business is still small-scale. The products I sell include fried snacks, mixed fruit ice, es teler, and various other light foods and drinks that are convenient for visitors to enjoy while at the event location.
3.	What is your average daily turnover on a regular day (outside the KKI event)?	Since I just started this business, I can't yet confirm my average daily turnover on regular days. My original plan was to only start selling regularly after this KKI event ended, so there isn't enough daily sales data to use as a reference yet.
4.	Did you already know about or previously attend the Indonesian Ship Contest (KKI) event?	I didn't know about, let alone attend, KKI before. However, because of the amount of information circulating about this event, I eventually learned about KKI and took the opportunity to sell here.
B. IMPACT ON MSMEs / TRADING BUSINESSES		
1.	Did your sales turnover increase during the KKI event? If so, roughly what percentage increase?	During KKI, my income averaged around Rp600,000 per day. That figure is still gross revenue, not yet reduced by capital costs. Since I just started this business and have no comparison turnover from regular days, I can't state what percentage the increase was. Even so, that income remains a meaningful addition for me as a novice trader.
2.	What products were most sought after by visitors during the KKI event?	Since many other traders sell similar products, my products weren't particularly sought after by visitors. However, my goods were still needed, especially when visitors felt thirsty or hungry amid the crowds. So my sales depended more on visitors' needs at that moment.

No.	Question	Informant's Answer
3.	Did you increase your stock of goods, selling hours, or helping staff during the event?	It depends on the situation on the ground. If buyers were plentiful and stock ran out early, I would add more stock to avoid losing customers. The additional amount wasn't much, since I only drew from supplies I had at home.
4.	Did you face any challenges while selling during KKI (for example, location, competition, cleanliness, security, or permits)?	The challenge I felt most was competition. Many traders sold the same products as mine, so buyers were spread across many stalls. As a result, my goods only sold out after quite a long time, or when the venue was truly packed with visitors.
5.	In your opinion, should events like KKI be held regularly every year? Why?	In my opinion, events like KKI should be held regularly every year because they greatly help MSMEs around the location. With KKI, a great many visitors come. The more visitors there are, the greater the opportunity for traders to attract buyers, which in turn helps the local economy's turnover.
6.	What are your hopes for the organizing committee or local government regarding future KKI events, so they can be more beneficial for traders?	Going forward, I hope the organizing committee and local government will pay more attention to the interests of traders, especially local MSME operators. Some of my hopes are: (1) that trading locations be arranged fairly and evenly, so that small and new traders have equal opportunities to sell in strategic spots; (2) that stalls or tents be provided at an affordable cost, or even free for local MSMEs if possible; (3) that the number of traders selling the same type of product be regulated, so that competition remains healthy and all traders have a chance to attract buyers; (4) that event promotion be expanded so more visitors come, including from outside the island; (5) that cleanliness, lighting, and security at the location be maintained throughout the event; and (6) that business coaching or training be provided for MSMEs so traders can develop, not just during KKI.

No.	Question	Informant's Answer
C. IMPACT ON TOURISM		
1.	In your observation, has the number of visitors/tourists around this location increased during KKI?	Yes, in my observation the number of visitors increased during KKI. This event attracted public attention, so people came in crowds to directly watch the various activities.
2.	Where did the visitors you met come from (local Bengkalis residents, other cities, or other regions)?	Most of the visitors I met came from within Bengkalis Island. This is natural since the event was held on Bengkalis Island, making it easiest for local residents to reach the location and attend.
3.	In your opinion, does KKI help introduce Bengkalis as a tourist destination?	In my personal opinion, yes. With KKI and coverage from various media, Bengkalis' name has become more widely known. I hope this can help Bengkalis become even more widely known, even at the international level.
4.	Were there any changes to the surrounding facilities (cleanliness, parking, lighting) during the event?	Yes, there were visible changes during the event. These changes were seen in the lighting, the availability of tents, and the cleanliness of the location, which received more attention.
D. IMPACT ON EDUCATION / ACADEMIA		
1.	Did you see many school or university students involved in or attending the KKI event, either as participants or organizing committee members?	Yes, a great many. I saw students from various levels, from elementary to junior and senior high school, and quite a few university students were also involved in this event.
2.	In your opinion, are events like KKI beneficial for the learning or skill development of the younger generation in Bengkalis?	Very beneficial. Through KKI, the younger generation of Bengkalis has the opportunity to meet people from outside the region and exchange knowledge. From this they can learn new things they didn't previously know, while also sharing the knowledge they already have, so their insight and skills develop as well.
3.	Have you ever been visited by students for coursework or research purposes related to KKI before?	Never. I'm just a local resident who sells goods, so no students have come to me so far for coursework or research related to KKI.

No.	Question	Informant's Answer
E. CLOSING QUESTIONS		
1.	Overall, do you feel that the KKI event has a positive impact on the economic life of the Bengkalis community?	In my opinion, the positive impact of KKI is mainly felt by me personally, together with my family. The income from selling during this event has become an addition that helps meet family needs.
2.	Do you have any additional suggestions or input regarding the KKI event?	I hope KKI continues to grow and is organized even better in the years to come. I also hope this event can be held here again, so the Bengkalis community can continue to feel its benefits.

DOCUMENTATION

Interview with a Local Trader at the 2026 KKI Event on Bengkalis Island



Figure 1. *Es teler and iced lemon-coconut juice stall*



Figure 2. *Trader serving buyers at the ice and risoles stall*



Figure 3. *Crowd of buyers in the stall area*



Figure 4. *Nico drinking iced tea, it's really hot this afternoon*



Figure 5. *Packaged food and cake stall*



Figure 6. *Assorted packaged food on the stall table*



Figure 7. *Rice bowl and assorted iced tea stall*



Figure 8. *Stuffed fried tofu stall*



Figure 9. *Group documentation at the event location*



Figure 10. *Interview with a trader at the iced tea stall*



Figure 11. *Atmosphere of the street and row of stalls, seen from a convex mirror*



Preparation before the contest



Time of the contest for a certain category



Ship model from UNIVERSITAS SRIWIJAYA participating in the ship contest



Group II Photo



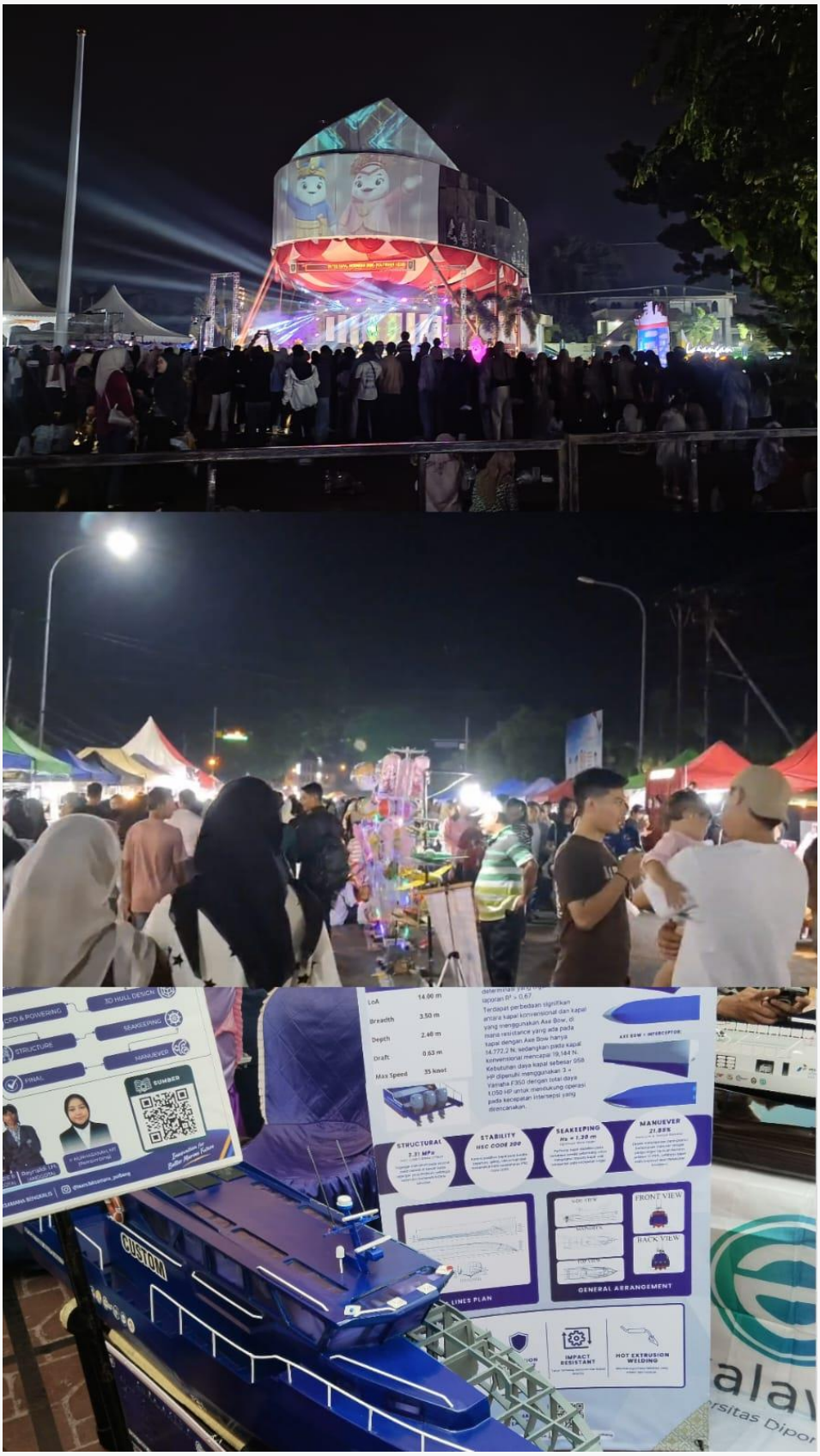
Some moments from the ship contest on campus



Some moments of Group II



Some moments of Group II



Contest Monument